

Shortly after the baby was born, Jackson and Linn's church took up a collection to help them with the additional hospital expenses. However, the extent of the medical bills was far beyond the means of their small church, and soon the bills were accumulating again. Jackson remembered Dr. Yuan's advice to consider filing for bankruptcy. Two other Christians also counseled Jackson to file for bankruptcy—to relieve some of the financial pressure.

In the meantime, the couple found that they were unable to meet their mortgage payments and the payments on a small debt on some furniture they had purchased. But since they had no real budget, they naturally assumed their financial problems were the result of the baby's medical expenses.

They soon began to develop an "I don't care" mentality about their finances. They assumed the situation was hopeless. Even though they continued to pray about their needs, they adopted the attitude of many Christians: praying but doubting if God would really answer.

They began to use their credit cards to fill the gaps in their budget. Jackson bought his gas on credit and ate out on credit; Linn bought baby supplies and groceries on credit. Without realizing it, they had adopted an attitude of despair and a philosophy that bankruptcy was inevitable. With no visible means to repay, they were running up bills and living beyond their means. Although the couple never would have robbed a bank, they were in effect doing the same thing: stealing from their creditors.

Seven months after Jordan was born, the couple was beginning to reap the seeds they had sown. Creditors were calling daily because nearly all their bills were delinquent. Two credit card companies had filed judgments against them, which they had ignored because they felt there was nothing that could be done anyway. When Jackson's pay was garnished, he was called into the office of the school administrator, Nick Swartz. "Jackson, I just received a notice of attachment from the court," Nick said solemnly. "I have to comply with the request and withhold 20 percent of your net pay. Are you having financial problems?"